

FIELD STUDY

Where the Shade Falls

A compact observation report about how people choose places to pause. All observations are fictional demonstration data.

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Executive note

People rarely chose the nearest available seat. In this fictional two-hour observation exercise, the preferred pause points combined shade, a clear view of the path, and a small amount of separation from through-traffic.

The report is intentionally modest. It demonstrates how a short field note can move from prose and a maintained worksheet into a polished, editable Word document without hiding the source.

The observations in this template are synthetic. Replace the sample workbook and wording before using the document for real research.

Study question

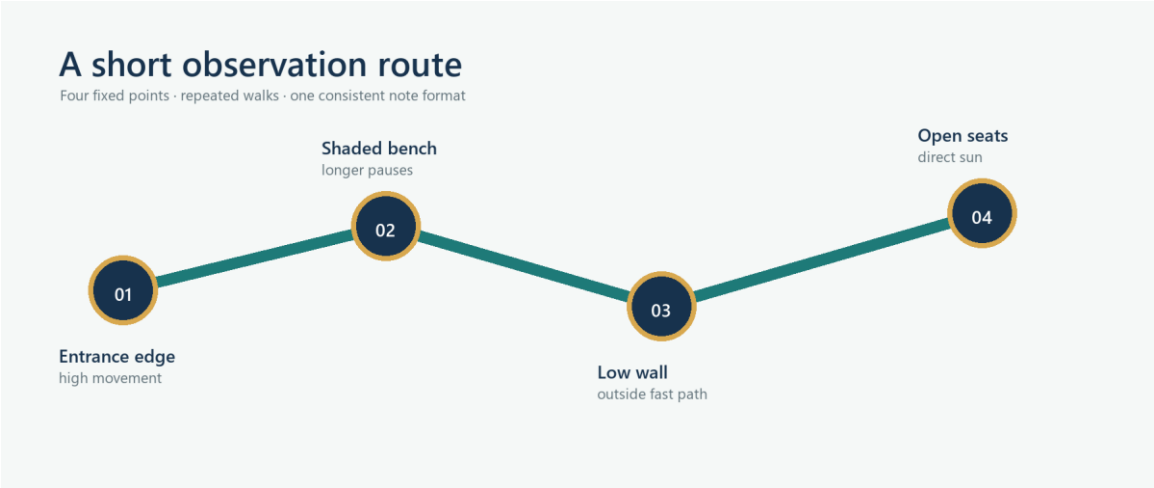
What visible conditions appear to influence where a person pauses along a short pedestrian route?

The exercise considers four simple cues:

- direct sun or shade;
- distance from the main walking line;
- an open or obstructed view;
- the presence of a usable edge, bench, or low wall.

Observation method

The route is divided into four points. A recorder walks the route every fifteen minutes and notes the conditions, approximate occupancy, and one short behavioral observation. No identifying information is collected.



Observation path and pause points

Reading the route

The map is a maintained image component. It can be replaced independently of this prose while retaining the same position, caption treatment, and document layout.

Observation record

The following table is compiled from an ordinary Excel Table. Its columns are defined by the workbook—not by the document engine.

Point	Time	Shade	People paused	Typical pause	Recorder note
01 · Entrance edge	09:00	Partial	3	Under 2 min	Mostly waiting for another person
02 · Shaded bench	09:15	Full	7	5–12 min	Several people stayed after checking a phone
03 · Low wall	09:30	Partial	5	3–7 min	Used as an informal seat outside the fast path
04 · Open seats	09:45	None	1	Under 2 min	Seat used briefly; direct sun on the surface
01 · Entrance edge	10:00	None	4	Under 2 min	High movement, few sustained pauses
02 · Shaded bench	10:15	Full	8	5–12 min	Two small groups shared the bench area
03 · Low wall	10:30	Partial	6	3–7 min	People retained a clear view of the path
04 · Open seats	10:45	None	2	Under 2 min	Short stops only

Interpretation

Three patterns are visible in the sample record.

1. The shaded bench attracted longer pauses than the exposed seats.
2. The low wall remained useful even without a formal seat because it sat outside the fastest walking line.
3. The point nearest the entrance had the highest movement count but the shortest pauses.

These are observations, not causal findings. A longer study would need repeated time periods, weather notes, and a clearer way to distinguish waiting, resting, and social activity.

Next field pass

For a real study, the next pass should keep the same route and add only the measurements that answer a defined question. A practical extension would be to record shade coverage at three fixed times and compare pause duration without changing the observation points.

The document can then be rebuilt with the same command; Word pagination, the table of contents, page furniture, and proof images are regenerated from the canonical sources.